

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A world map with dashed blue lines radiating from various points, likely representing international relations or trade routes. The map includes labels for continents and oceans. India is highlighted in a darker shade of blue.

INDIA DURING COLD WAR

MODULE - 2

BEGINNING OF COLD WAR

The end of the Second World War in 1945 drastically changed the international scenario

- 1** The Second World War was characterized by use of nuclear bombs, mass killings and direct-armed confrontation between groups.
- 2** After the defeat of the Axis powers- Japan and Germany in 1945, the world was dominated by the rivalry between the warring groups, United States and USSR, both trying to contain the other
- 3** The horrors of the war especially in Japan and Germany made the made countries of the world realize that because of Mutually Assured Destruction, war should not be an option.



BEGINNING OF COLD WAR

- 4 But tensions and a series of confrontations became a new phenomenon in International politics.
- 5 Thus, after the end of the WWII, the victors of the war USA and USSR began a diplomatic and ideological clash; a struggle of military alliances and balance of power.
- 6 This came to be known as the 'Cold War' because unlike the direct armed struggle of the World wars, the Cold war symbolized a political, strategic, economic and ideological war.

1. The Cold War (1945-1991) Democracy vs. Communism



FIRST WORLD AND SECOND WORLD

- 1** USA led the western governed by the principles of Capital and free market economy.
- 2** They stood for liberal democracies and political rights and freedoms. This group came to be known as the First World
- 3** The Second World was led by Union of Soviet Socialists Republics(USSR) or Soviet Union following the Socialist principles of state-controlled economy and society.



FIRST WORLD AND SECOND WORLD

- 4 The Berlin Wall in Germany symbolized the divide between the First and the Second World.
- 5 In this Bi-polar world, the powers did not fight with each other directly but through proxies.
- 6 The US and Soviet Union divided Europe into (North Atlantic Treaty Organization) NATO-led democratic western Europe in 1949 and the Warsaw Pact-led Communist Eastern Europe in 1955; to counter NATO's forces in Europe.



This trend of alliances and counter alliances created an atmosphere of chaos and confusion in the international politics.

DETERRENCE IN COLD WAR

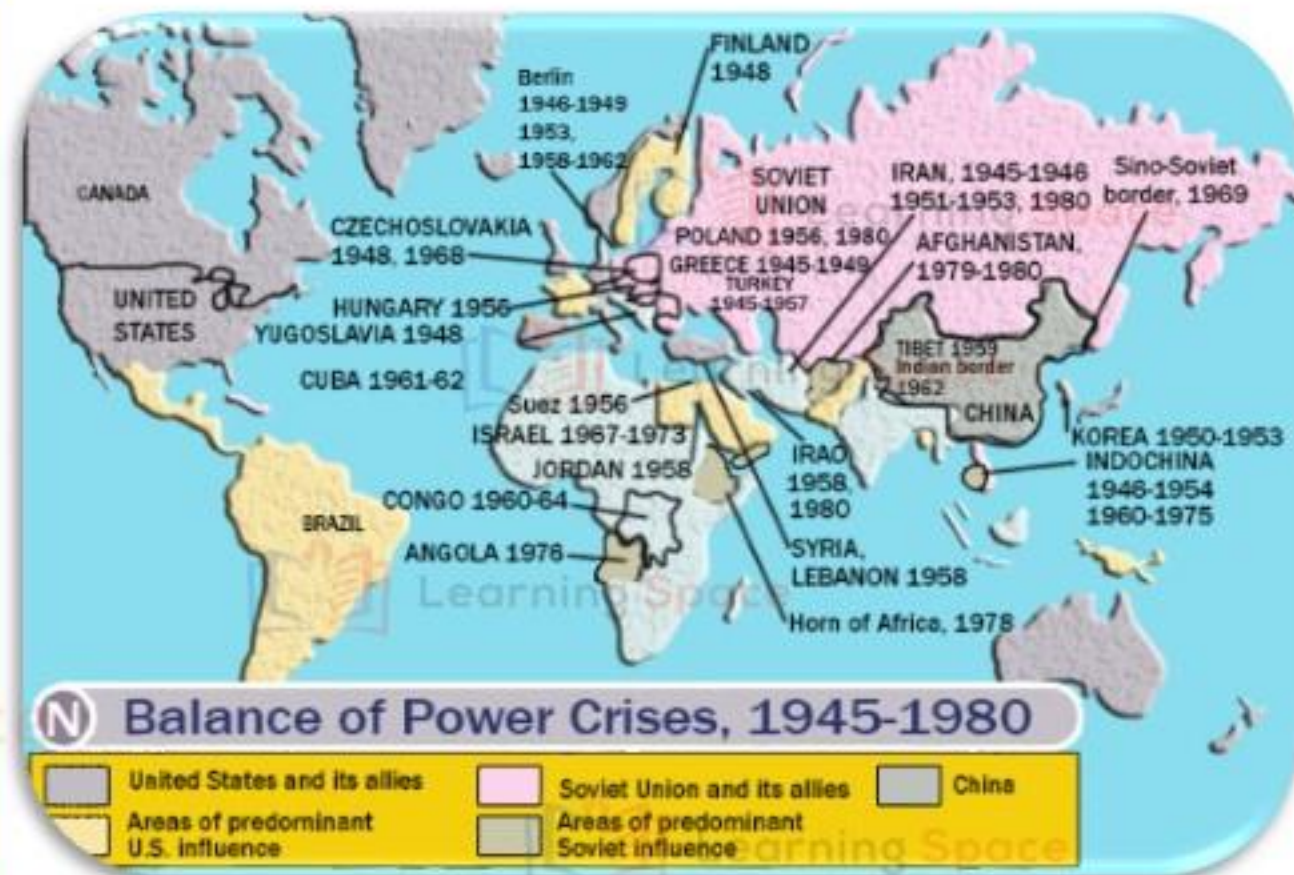
- 1** Cold War was based on the logic of deterrence. In these circumstances, both sides were nuclear powers and had the capacity to retaliate against an attack and cause lot of destruction.
- 2** But the arms race continued as the suspicion of a possible attack always loomed large. This principle of deterrence prevented war, but not rivalry between the superpowers.
- 3** The powers acted responsible and had to restrain avoiding a full-fledged war.
- 4** Following this restraint, the superpowers entered into agreements- Nuclear Non Proliferation Treaty, Limited Test ban Treaty, Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty, Strategic Arms Limitation Talks and Strategic Arms Reduction Treaty.



COLD WAR RIVALRIES

5 The smaller states used to align themselves with either of the power blocs for strategic, economic and political purposes. These smaller states became the main arena conflict.

6 The superpowers needed them for access to resources like oil and minerals, territories, strategic locations, economic support and ideological support.



BERLIN WALL

- 1 After increasing tensions between the Soviets and the Western powers during the first 15 years of the Cold War, the Soviet Union decided to build a physical barrier between East and West Berlin.
- 2 This barrier was a symbolic “Iron Curtain” with the Western powers occupying the Western portion and the Soviet Union occupying the East.
- 3 The main purpose of the Wall was to prevent East Germans from fleeing, thus stopping an economically disastrous migration of workers.



Map showing the way Europe was divided into rival alliances during the Cold War

BERLIN WALL

4 With the closing of the East-West sector boundary in Berlin, the vast majority of East Germans could no longer travel or emigrate to West Germany.

5 Many families were split, and East Berliners employed in the West were cut off from their jobs. West Berlin became an isolated exclave in a hostile land.



THIRD WORLD

- 1** The Cold War was also marked with the emergence of newly achieved independent countries in Asia Africa and Latin America as a result of rapid decolonization.
- 2** These countries, led by India, did not want to be under the control of superpower after having struggled for independence.
- 3** They wanted to be sovereign, develop and independent foreign policy and pursue its national interest.
- 4** In the Cold War situation, these countries felt joining either of the power blocs would jeopardize her independence and lead to a new form of imperialism.
- 5** Hence, this opposition to gave birth to the concept of non-alignment.



NON ALIGNED MOVEMENT

1 Thus in 1961 at Belgrade, India's PM Nehru, Yugoslavia's Josip Tito, Egypt's Abdel Nasser, Indonesia's Sukarno and Ghana's Nkrumah founded NAM.

2 Non Alignment stood as a challenge to the dominance of the superpowers to establish a New International Economic Order (NIEO) to attain economic development and political independence.

- Non-alignment did not mean isolation in international affairs or neutrality on issues of global importance.
- The countries played an active role in mediating between rival alliances to support peace and stability. They were vocal in matters of international importance.



NON ALIGNED MOVEMENT

- NAM was instrumental in the bringing attention to the issues of Third World countries through UNCTAD report of 1972 titled Towards a New Trade Policy for development.
- NAM began to function as an economic pressure group.
- It was vocal against human rights violation, threat to sovereignty and a just world order.
- Standing to democratize international systems, and stood for **South-South cooperation**.



However, by the end of the Cold War and disintegration of USSR, the relevance of NAM was being questioned by scholars.

PM NEHRU'S FOREIGN POLICY

- 1**
 - India decided not to join either of the two blocs in the interest of economic development, to maintain independent judgment in evaluating and deciding foreign affairs and to follow independent foreign policy, to safeguard interests and to promote the international peace.
 - NAM helped India to take international decisions and stances suited to its own national interests
 - It was able to balance between the two superpower powers without taking any sides.
- 2**

Thus, India's post-independence foreign policy was based on the principles of nonalignment and peaceful co-existence.

 - This policy was advocated by both Mahatma Gandhi and Jawaharlal Nehru
 - It helped India to gain an international status and position in the global arena.



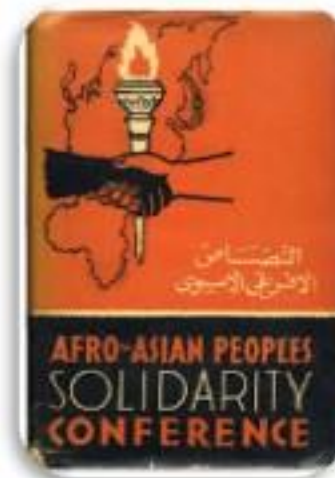
INDIA'S NON-ALIGNMENT

- 1 Thus, with Non-Alignment, India established diplomatic relations with many independent States.
- 2 India was a member of United Nations and took part in the Commonwealth of Nations.
- 3 The policy of non-alignment in India was based on the five principles of Panchsheel, enumerating International conduct.
 - Mutual respect for each other's territorial integrity and sovereignty
 - Non-aggression
 - Non-interference in each other's military affairs
 - Equality and mutual benefit
 - Peaceful co-existence.



OPPOSITION TO RACISM AND IMPERIALISM

- 1** India opposed all forms of racism, especially apartheid in South Africa.
- 2** India made efforts towards Afro-Asian solidarity. In 1955, Prime Minister Nehru participated in the Afro-Asian Conference held in Bandung and popularized the policy of non-alignment.
- 3** He stood for economic and cultural cooperation, respect for human rights and self-determination and promotion of world peace.
- 4** Under his leadership, India convened the Asian Relations Conference in March 1947.
- 5** India supported freedom of Indonesia from the Dutch colonial regime by convening an international conference in 1949 to support its freedom struggle.



COMMONWEALTH OF NATIONS

- 1 By signing the London Declaration and joined the Commonwealth. India accepted the British monarch as the symbol of the free association of its independent member nations and the head of Commonwealth.

2 This allowed India to maintain friendly relations with not only Britain, but other British Commonwealth countries as well.



INDIA IN VIETNAM

- 1 In its support for struggles for independence, India supported struggles for independence from France in Vietnam.
- 2 It also opposed American intervention of supporting the South and engaging in a military conflict with the North in the Vietnam War.
- 3 India, on the other hand, supported North Vietnam without conducting military hostilities
- 4 India also supported unification of Vietnam.



SUEZ CANAL CRISIS

- 1** Suez Canal was a man-made waterway built in 1869 separating Egypt from Sinai peninsula.
- 2** Its strategic importance lies in its connectivity from Mediterranean Sea to Indian Ocean through the Red Sea shipping goods from Europe to Asia.
- 3** This canal was nationalized by Egyptian leader Nasser in 1956. This was after two years of pressurizing British of ending their military presence in the region and border clashes with Israeli soldiers.
- 4** When Nasser nationalized the canal and began building the Aswan Dam with the support of Soviet arms and resources, the British opposed the move and supported the French .



SUEZ CANAL CRISIS

- 5 The British and French supported the Israeli outrage in October 1956 and gained control over the Suez Canal. In response, Soviet Union threatened to use nuclear weapons if British and French did not withdraw their forces.
- 6 USA threatened Britain, France and Israel to withdraw troops leading end of the Suez Canal crisis.
- 7 India supported secular nationalism in West Asia and encouraged Egypt to have a non-aligned posture.
- 8 But when the situation turned violent India took measures to mediate and asked US to intervene and support the cause for peace through the Eisenhower-Nehru formula. It also supported the Egyptian delegate in UN.



*India, thus remained non-committal
and engaged at the UN*

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